FREE CHECKLIST FOR THERAPISTS

Google Business Profile Checklist

The therapy-specific details most practices miss on their Google Business Profile, in one printable checklist you can work through in an afternoon.

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checklists, from setup to monthly upkeep

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review replies that never confirm someone is a client

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fill-in template for your business description

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START HERE

Before you start

Your Google Business Profile is what shows up on Google Maps and in the local results when someone searches "therapist near me". For many practices it brings in more calls than the website does.

Can your practice have a profile?

Usually yes

- You see clients in person at a real office address.
- You're there, or staffed, during the hours you list.
- You see clients online too, as long as you also see people in person at that office.

Usually no

- You only see clients by video and have no office where you meet them.
- The address is a virtual office or mailbox.
- It's a room you rent by the hour and don't use regularly.

Telehealth-only practice? Google's guidelines don't allow profiles for businesses with no in-person location. Don't list your home address or a virtual office to get around it: it can get the profile suspended. Put that effort into your website, directory profiles and other local listings instead.

Solo or group?

A solo practitioner can usually have one profile for the practice. In a group practice, the practice can have its own profile, and individual clinicians who see the public can often have their own too. Agree who owns each one, and use the same address and phone number on all of them.

Rules change. Google updates these guidelines regularly. Check the current Google Business Profile guidelines before you set up or make big changes.

01 · CHECKLIST

Name, category and the basics

Get these right once and you rarely need to touch them again. Get them wrong and the profile can be suspended.

Practice name

- [ ] The name matches what's on your door, your website and your paperwork, exactly.
- [ ] No extra keywords or towns added, like "Anxiety Therapy Denver". It breaks Google's rules and is a common reason for suspension.
- [ ] If you practise under your own name, use it the way clients would see it, for example "Jane Smith, LMFT".

Categories

- [ ] The primary category is the closest match to what you do, such as Psychotherapist, Psychologist or Counselor.
- [ ] A few secondary categories for what you also offer, such as family or couples counselling. Only ones that are true.

Contact details

- [ ] The address is the office where you see clients, written the same way everywhere online.
- [ ] The phone number is one you answer, or that goes to voicemail you check daily.
- [ ] The website link goes to your home page or a page for that location, not to a directory.
- [ ] The booking or appointment link is added if you take bookings online.

02 · CHECKLIST

Photos, hours and services

This is what someone looks at before they call. Make it feel like walking in the door.

- [ ] A clear photo of the building or entrance, so people can find you on the day.
- [ ] The waiting area and the room where you see clients, tidy and well lit.
- [ ] A recent, friendly photo of each clinician, with their permission.
- [ ] No stock photos, and no clients in any photo, ever.
- [ ] Hours are real, and holiday hours are added before each holiday.
- [ ] Services are listed one by one, such as individual therapy, couples therapy or EMDR.
- [ ] Useful details are ticked where they apply, such as wheelchair access or online appointments.

Your business description

FILL IN

[Practice name] is a **[solo / group]** therapy practice in **[neighbourhood, town]** helping **[who you help]** with **[two or three main issues]**. We offer **[in-person and online]** sessions and **[take (insurance) / offer a sliding scale]**. **[Book a free 15-minute call to see if we're a good fit.]**

Keep it factual. No links, no phone numbers, no promises of results and no "best therapist in town" claims in the description.

03 · REVIEWS

Reviews, without confirming a client

Even saying "thanks for coming in" confirms that a person is your client. Your reply has to protect their privacy, whatever they wrote.

Asking for reviews

- [ ] I've checked my licensing board's rules and ethics code. Many discourage or prohibit asking current clients for reviews or testimonials.
- [ ] I don't offer anything in return for a review, and I don't only ask people I expect to be happy.
- [ ] Where it's appropriate, I ask colleagues, referral partners or people who attended a public talk or group.

Replies you can use

REVIEW	REPLY
Positive	Thank you for taking the time to share this. We're glad to hear our practice feels welcoming.
Negative	We take all feedback seriously. To protect everyone's privacy we can't discuss anything here, but we'd welcome a call on [phone].
Clearly not a client	We can't find any record that matches this. If we've got that wrong, please call us on [phone] so we can talk.
Fake or abusive	Don't reply in anger. Report it through your profile, keep a screenshot and reply with the negative template if you reply at all.

Never mention a diagnosis, a session, a time you met or anything the reviewer told you, even if they posted it themselves.

04 · UPKEEP

Monthly upkeep

Twenty minutes, once a month. Put it in your calendar now.

Every month

- [ ] Hours, phone number and booking link are still right.
- [ ] New reviews have a reply, using the templates on page 5.
- [ ] I've checked for edits suggested by Google or the public, and fixed anything wrong.
- [ ] A new photo is added if anything has changed at the office.
- [ ] I've glanced at the profile's insights: calls, website clicks and direction requests.

Every three months

- [ ] Services and the description still match what I offer now.
- [ ] Clinician photos and names are current, and anyone who has left is removed.
- [ ] My name, address and phone are the same on my website and main directories.
- [ ] I know who else has access to manage the profile, and remove anyone who shouldn't.

Moving office? Update the profile on the day you move, not before. Google may ask you to verify the new address, sometimes by video, so leave time for it.

ONE MORE THING

Your profile gets you on the map. Your website gets the booking.

When someone finds you on Maps, the next thing they tap is your website. If it says the same things and makes booking easy, the call is a lot more likely.

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- Local SEO so you're found in your city and on Google Maps
- Websites written in your voice, from one conversation
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